YELEN DIGITAL

*Illuminating your brand*

PRACTICAL GUIDE FOR SMEs

# 7 SIGNALS

## THAT DAMAGE THE IMAGE OF YOUR SME ONLINE

*The 10-minute test to find out where you stand.*

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BEFORE YOU START

# They have already judged you.

Before a tender, a job interview or a first meeting, the person across the table looks you up online. They compare your website, your LinkedIn and your social channels, and decide within minutes whether to take you seriously.

This guide gives you **7 signals** to check. Each one takes 2 minutes to test, with your phone and your computer.

## HOW TO USE IT

1. Take your phone and your computer.
2. Search for your company the way a customer, a candidate or a partner would.
3. Tick each signal you pass, then add up your score out of 7 (last page).

> *Be strict. A decision-maker won't cut you any slack.*

# 01

CHANNEL CONSISTENCY

## One voice everywhere

IN THE FIELD CONSULTING FIRM

The website claims “industry leader”, LinkedIn hasn't been updated in a year and the Facebook page shows an old logo. The prospect no longer knows what is true.

### WHAT IT COSTS YOU

Between two providers, the decision-maker remembers the one where everything is consistent. The other looks poorly run.

### THE BENCHMARK

Same name, same logo, same promise and same figures on every channel.

2-MINUTE TEST

Place your website, your LinkedIn and your Facebook page side by side.

**Passed if:** a stranger recognises them as the same company.

☐ I pass this signal

# 02

WEBSITE AND CONVERSION

## A website that drives action

IN THE FIELD PRIVATE SCHOOL

The site presents the school in detail, but the enrolment form is buried at the bottom of the page and the phone number isn't clickable on mobile.

### WHAT IT COSTS YOU

Every visit without action is a lost enrolment, even though you paid to generate it.

### THE BENCHMARK

One clear action, visible without scrolling, designed for the phone first.

**2-MINUTE TEST**

Open your website on your phone and try to contact yourself.

**Passed if:** you manage it in fewer than 3 clicks.

☐ I pass this signal

# 03

VISIBLE EXPERTISE

## Prove what you know

IN THE FIELD PRIVATE CLINIC

Recognised practitioners, but no content to show it: no advice, no testimonial, no face. The clinic looks like all the others.

### WHAT IT COSTS YOU

Without visible proof, competition is about price or proximity, never about quality.

### THE BENCHMARK

One piece of expertise content a month, delivered by a real person from the company.

**2-MINUTE TEST**

Count your pieces of content from the last 3 months that show your know-how.

**Passed if:** you find at least 3.

☐ I pass this signal

# 04

ONLINE REPUTATION

## What is said about you

IN THE FIELD HOTEL

Negative reviews have gone unanswered on Google for months. Travellers read management's reply as much as the review itself.

### WHAT IT COSTS YOU

One ignored review weighs more than ten positive ones, because it shows how you treat an unhappy customer.

### THE BENCHMARK

A reply to every review, positive or negative, within 48 hours, in the name of management.

**2-MINUTE TEST**

Read your last 10 reviews and see which ones have a reply.

**Passed if:** all of them do.

☐ I pass this signal

# 05

EMPLOYER IMAGE

## Attract the right profiles

IN THE FIELD CONSTRUCTION COMPANY

The company is recruiting site managers, but its LinkedIn page shows no teams, no sites, no values. The candidate who checks finds nothing and applies elsewhere.

### WHAT IT COSTS YOU

The best profiles compare before applying. You lose talent you will never see.

### THE BENCHMARK

Show the team, the projects and life at the company, with real faces.

**2-MINUTE TEST**

Search for your company the way a candidate would.

**Passed if:** you see people, projects and values.

☐ I pass this signal

# 06

BRAND VOICE

## Who speaks for you?

IN THE FIELD MICROFINANCE

An unhappy customer writes on the page. Three employees reply, each in their own way, one of them from a personal profile.

### WHAT IT COSTS YOU

A clumsy reply is seen, captured and shared. In finance, trust is lost in a single message.

### THE BENCHMARK

One designated person, a defined tone, a written procedure for sensitive cases.

**2-MINUTE TEST**

Ask your team who answers a negative comment, and how.

**Passed if:** everyone gives the same answer.

☐ I pass this signal

# 07

PERFORMANCE TRACKING

## Decide with numbers

### IN THE FIELD

RETAIL

The communication budget rises every year, but management receives no report. Nobody knows what generated enquiries.

### WHAT IT COSTS YOU

A budget you can't defend becomes the first one cut.

### THE BENCHMARK

A monthly report of three numbers: reach, engagement, enquiries generated.

### 2-MINUTE TEST

Ask your team or your provider for the latest communication report.

**Passed if:** it is less than a month old and makes sense without explanation.

☐ I pass this signal

YOUR SCORE

# Where do you stand?

One point per signal passed.

| | |
|---|---|
| **7** out of 7 | A solid foundation. The real question becomes growth: going further, faster. |
| **5-6** out of 7 | Good foundations, but leaks. Every missing point is a customer, a talent or a partner who walks past you. |
| **3-4** out of 7 | Your image is working against you on several fronts. A serious decision-maker will hesitate. |
| **0-2** out of 7 | Today, your online image is costing you customers and talent, without you seeing it. |

## Send us your score.

Simply reply to this message with your score (example: 4/7). We'll tell you in a few lines where to start.

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